

Firearms Trace Data: Alaska - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Alaska in Calendar Year 2023

1,682

Firearm Types with an Alaska Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	936
Rifles	348
Shotguns	171
Revolvers	164
Receivers/Frames	46
Machineguns	5
Derringers	4
Unknown Types	4
Combinations	3
Silencer	1

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with an Alaska Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	462
.22 Cal	205
12GA	132

.45 Cal	130
.40 Cal	107
.380 Cal	72
10mm	68
5.56mm	45
.357 Cal	43
MULTI	42

NOTE: There were 294 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 82 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Alaska Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	350
Possession of Weapon	293
Weapon Offense	228
Traffic Offense	141
Found Firearm	137
Dangerous Drugs	110
Simple Assault	97
Property Crimes	69
Homicide	55
Suicide	52

NOTE: There were 150 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Alaska	1,101
Colorado	26
Florida	15
Texas	14
Washington	14
Arizona	12
California	10
Oregon	10
Virginia	8
Georgia	7
Ohio	7
Oklahoma	7
Michigan	6
North Carolina	6
Pennsylvania	5

NOTE: An additional 26 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 61 other traces. The source state was identified in 1,309 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	79
3 Months to Under 7 Months	66
7 Months to Under 1 Year	69
1 Year to Under 2 Years	139
2 Years to Under 3 Years	107
3 Years and Over	847

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Alaska Average Time-to-Crime: **8.57 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	29
18 to 21	94
22 to 24	92
25 to 30	169
31 to 40	418
41 to 50	249
Over 50	355

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Alaska Average Age of Possessor: **42 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Anchorage	947
Kenai	205
Wasilla	109
Fairbanks	82
Ninilchik	57
Soldotna	46
Juneau	44
Eagle River	41
North Pole	28
Chugiak	14

NOTE: There were 27 additional municipalities that accounted for 109 other traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Alaska. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Alaska.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.

- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with an Alaska Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Alaska Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Alaska Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024